

Ἀραιθός ὁ ἱστορικός

Araethus the Historian and the Arcadian Fragments

eul_aid: ela

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)

Dialect: *Ἀττική* [Attic \(frg\)](#)

Domain: *Ἱστορία* [History](#)

Format: *Πεζός* [Prose](#)

Araethus the Historian was a Greek historian of the 4th century BCE. No biographical details survive; he is known only through citations by later authors.

He is credited with a single known work, **Cretan Matters**, which is now lost. It survives only in fragmentary citations. The Suda attributes **Cretan Matters** and a work **On Rhodes** to an "Araethus," though this may conflate multiple individuals. One fragment, preserved by Herodian in the **Etymologicum Magnum**, concerns Cretan dialect. Another possible fragment in Athenaeus's **Deipnosophistae** references Cretan dining customs.

Araethus is a minor figure in Greek historiography, significant only as a representative of local history focused on Crete. His work belonged to the genre of horography or ethnography, containing details on Cretan customs and dialect. He is occasionally cited in modern scholarship on fragmentary historians of Crete, but the scant evidence precludes substantive analysis.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Arcadian Historical Fragments](#) · 7 passages